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Deputy Senior Security Advisor

Cabinet Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 22nd November 2026

Cabinet Office

Reference number

487385

Salary

£76,454 - £83,355

Starting pay on promotion is the highest of either: the minimum of the new Cabinet Office pay range/grade an increase to existing pay of 10%

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 6

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

CO - Chief Operating Officer Office - Cabinet Office Security and Resilience

Type of role

Security

Working pattern

Full-time, Job share

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

London

About the job

Job summary

This is a specialist security role where you will work in close partnership with the Government Security Group (GSG), the National Technical Authorities, and National Security stakeholders, to ensure the security and continual operations of the Cabinet Office s higher classification operations.

Job description

Represent Cabinet Office within the cross-government security community and work closely with the National Technical Authorities and UKIC.

Ensure higher classification IT services and infrastructure meet the operational demands of the department and are resilient

Oversee the processing of STRAP applications and accounts ensuring that SLA s are achieved. Provide recommendations to enhance delivery, both internally and for the wider enterprise and ensure technology is used to optimise delivery.

Implementing the Government Security Group policy and processes across all areas of classified material and infrastructure ensuring that protocols and requirements are both managed and delivered across the department and key stakeholders.

Lead investigations into higher classification security incidents and breaches, working collaboratively with GSG and other relevant partners.

Oversee the installation of physical security measures and IT infrastructure of higher classification spaces.

Provide assurance that existing higher classifications meet the requirements of partners and ensure these continually evolve to meet the changing needs of the department and threat landscape.

Brief and influence up to board and Ministerial level with both internal and external stakeholders.

Responsible for overseeing the development of, and improvements to, departmental security culture, training and awareness when it comes to higher classification working. The role holder should be confident in leveraging cross government and departmental partners and utilising technology to streamline processes and enhance customer experiences.

Manage the multi-million pound security and resilience budget for the whole team ensuring public money is managed effectively and in line with financial controls.

Provide strategic leadership for the STRAP and InfoCap teams.

Be part of the Cabinet Office Security & Resilience Senior Leadership Team.

Carry out other security & resilience related activity as directed by the Senior Security Advisor.

Deputising for the Senior Security Advisor where required.

Promote the Government Security profession and advise/support the Government Security Group on future risk policy as well as driving the professional development of yourself and your team.

Person specification

Essential criteria

Deep experience of the national security threat landscape and significant experience working with operational national security partners to manage real-world threats.

Experience of the STRAP protective security regime and practical experience working with classified material

Proven leadership, decision making and ability to deliver through others with evidence of sound operational judgements.

Outstanding interpersonal/communication skills in order to work collaboratively with internal and external stakeholders to engender trust, cooperation and buy in.

Significant experience managing risk in a dynamic environment which anticipates legal, political and reputational risk.

A high degree of personal resilience to manage rapidly emerging operational demands and a high level of fluidity.

Proven and demonstrable experience of managing and delivering projects within taut time frames and budgetary limitations.

This post requires British nationality and Developed Vetting (DV) clearance. As the post holder will have access to very sensitive information, there are limitations on travelling to a small number of countries and we

will undertake additional security checks as part of the recruitment process. Applications from candidates with close connections to certain countries may take considerably longer to process, or in some cases result in a withdrawal of an offer of employment. Further details will be provided at the conditional offer stage.

Additional information:

Cabinet Office policy is that a minimum 60% of your working time should be spent at your principal workplace. For some roles, due to their nature and the business need, this may be up to 100%. Requirements to attend other locations for official business will also count towards this level of attendance.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

- Leadership
- Delivering at Pace
- Seeing the Big Picture
- Communicating and Influencing

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £76,454, Cabinet Office contributes £22,148 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

- Learning and development tailored to your role.
- An environment with flexible working options.
- A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity.
- A Civil Service Pension which provides an attractive pension, benefits for dependants and employer contributions of 28.97%.
- A minimum of 25 days of paid annual leave, increasing by one day per year up to a maximum of 30.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using Success Profiles (opens in a new window), and will assess your Behaviours and Experience.

Application process

Please submit a CV and a 750 word personal statement.

Further details around what this will entail are listed on the application form.

Please provide a Personal Statement demonstrating your suitability against the essential criteria.

Initial sift on CV and personal statement.

These will be assessed at sift. Should a large number of applications be received, an initial sift may be undertaken using the CV only.

If you pass sift you will be invited to do a recorded video interview as part of the long-list of candidates.

If you pass the recorded video interview you will be invited for an in person interview.

Selection process

Short video presentation for long list candidates (topic will be provided at a later date).

Interview for short listed candidates.

The video will be a presentation on a topic shared nearer to the time; the in person interview will be based on experience and behaviours.

Expected timeline (subject to change)

Expected sift date WC 23 Nov

Expected interview date/s Long list WC 7 Dec - interviews WC 7 Dec

Interview location - Your interview will either be conducted face to face or by video. You will be notified of the location if you are selected for interview.

Reasonable Adjustment

If a person with disabilities is put at a substantial disadvantage compared to a non-disabled person, we have a duty to make reasonable changes to our processes.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should:

Contact Government Recruitment Service via cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Assistance required section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at an interview, or if you re deaf, a Language Service Professional.

Further Information

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

A reserve list may be held for a period of 12 months from which further appointments can be made.

Any move to Cabinet Office from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare; for further information visit the Childcare Choices website.

If successful and transferring from another Government Department a criminal record check may be carried out.

In order to process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure and Barring Service on your behalf.

However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms direct. If you will be doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing Pre-EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant s details held on the IFD will be refused employment.

A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

This role is full time only. Applicants who wish to work an alternative pattern are welcome to apply however your preferred working pattern may not be available and you should discuss this with the vacancy holder before applying.

Please note that this role requires DV clearance, which would normally need 10 years UK residency in the past 10 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For further information on National Security Vetting please visit the Demystifying Vetting website.

Please note terms and conditions are attached. Please take time to read the document to determine how these may affect you.

Feedback

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a standard (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is developed vetting (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : adam.jones1@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Email : adam.jones1@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission s Recruitment Principles. If you feel that your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and wish to make a complaint, then in the first instance you should contact Government Recruitment Service by email at : cabinetofficerecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk
If you are not satisfied with the response you receive, then you can contact the Civil Service Commission at info@csc.gov.uk. For further information on the Recruitment Principles and bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission, please visit their website at: https:// civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/.

Civil Service Commission

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